



D5.3

DisInforMeter Policy Report

A population indicator for FIMI receptivity and detection across Europe and its neighbourhood

Project Information

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DEDICATION

This deliverable is dedicated to the memory of Justina Baršytė, a dear friend and a valued colleague, whose inspiration and vision made this work possible.

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Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Definition
AVE	Average Variance Extracted
BRMS	Bayesian Regression Modelling in Stan
CFA	Confirmatory Factor Analysis
CFI	Comparative Fit Index
CI	Confidence Interval
DG CONNECT	Directorate-General for Communications Networks, Content and Technology
DSA	Digital Services Act
EDMO	European Digital Media Observatory
EEAS	European External Action Service
ERGA	European Regulators Group for Audiovisual Media Services
FDR	False Discovery Rate
FIMI	Foreign Information Manipulation and Interference
JRC	Joint Research Centre of the European Commission
MLR	Maximum Likelihood with Robust standard errors
RMSEA	Root Mean Square Error of Approximation
SEM	Structural Equation Modelling
StratCom	Strategic Communication
VLOP	Very Large Online Platform

Table 1: Abbreviations

1. Executive Summary

European policy already monitors the supply side of foreign information manipulation and interference (FIMI): narratives, incidents, platform behaviour, coordinated campaigns, and cross-border threat activity. What remains less standardised is the audience side. Policy teams still lack a validated population indicator showing whether publics detect manipulative foreign-origin content, which receptivity-relevant domains are aligned with detection or blind spots, and where survey, narrative-monitoring, and platform evidence should be combined (EEAS 2024; EEAS 2025; EEAS 2026; European Parliament and Council of the European Union 2022).

The DisInforMeter fills that gap. Across five studies and more than 10,000 respondents, it measures five affective-cognitive domains: Threat, Betrayal/Abandonment, Fear/Pragmatism, Foreign-Power Admiration, and a General Anchor. Higher DisInforMeter domain scores mean higher receptivity-relevant endorsement. In the multinational fielding, the DisInforMeter domains are paired with a FIMI detection criterion, where higher FIMI scores mean better detection of confirmed FIMI cases.

KEY MESSAGES

- 1 **FIMI detection is uneven across countries.** Some publics recognise confirmed FIMI cases more readily than others, and these differences are large enough to justify a standing audience-side indicator. Lower detection should be read as a policy-relevant blind spot, not as a judgement on a population.
- 2 **Source origin changes what audiences detect.** In the current item bank, Chinese-origin FIMI is detected less readily than Russian-origin FIMI across the participating countries. Source-specific reporting is therefore not a technical detail; it is central to understanding where detection gaps sit.
- 3 **Detection and receptivity-relevant endorsement are different policy signals.** A country can show relatively strong FIMI detection while also having specific source blind spots, or show elevated receptivity-relevant endorsement without the same detection profile. Country profiles should be read as diagnostics, not one-dimensional risk rankings.
- 4 **There is no single generic "FIMI vulnerability" profile.** The same receptivity-relevant domain can be associated with better detection in one source context and weaker detection in another. Monitoring and resilience work should therefore preserve domain profiles and source-specific detection instead of collapsing them into one score.
- 5 **The evidence base supports policy monitoring, with clear boundaries.** The core domains are reliable, comparable enough for profile and relationship analysis, and linked to civic attitudes already relevant to democracy and resilience monitoring. Absolute latent-mean comparisons and causal claims require caution and follow-up evidence.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Establish DisInforMeter as a recurring country indicator

DG CONNECT, the EDMO Central Hub, ERGA members, and national media authorities should pilot the Short DisInforMeter and a source-balanced FIMI detection battery in country factsheets and monitoring waves. Each report should show domain profiles, source-specific detection, uncertainty, scoring direction, and comparability caveats together.

2. Pair population evidence with platform and narrative evidence

DSA risk teams, vetted researchers, VLOP risk-assessment teams, EDMO hubs, and EEAS StratCom should combine DisInforMeter indicators with platform-exposure and narrative-monitoring data. The strongest policy signal is the intersection of high exposure, low detection, and elevated receptivity-relevant endorsement, analysed only at aggregate level.

3. Keep source-specific FIMI detection visible in StratCom workflows

EEAS StratCom and FIMI Defender workflows should report Russian-origin and Chinese-origin detection separately when item banks include both. The current evidence should be treated as a monitoring hypothesis for Chinese-origin blind spots, not as a claim about all state, domestic, or hybrid actors.

4. Use country profiles to target follow-up evidence and interventions

EDMO hubs, national authorities, ERGA members, and civil-society partners should use the country profiles to decide where to refresh FIMI item banks, request platform evidence, commission narrative review, or evaluate media-literacy and prebunking interventions. Country profiles should not be communicated as league tables.

5. Fund the next measurement step and publish the reusable package

DG RTD, JRC, the consortium, and national survey infrastructures should fund longitudinal and expanded-country fielding, then publish the final wording, translations, scoring rules, source tables, figure code, and caveats under an open reuse licence wherever consent and data-protection constraints allow. Trend, intervention, and causal claims require repeated waves.

Boundary of interpretation

The DisInforMeter is a population-monitoring and survey-research instrument. It is not an individual risk-profiling tool, a content-moderation tool, or a stand-alone basis for enforcement. S4 FIMI figures show detection of confirmed FIMI cases, where higher means better detection; DisInforMeter domain scores show receptivity-relevant endorsement, where higher means more endorsement. Country results are evidence for policy prioritisation and follow-up analysis, not country verdicts.

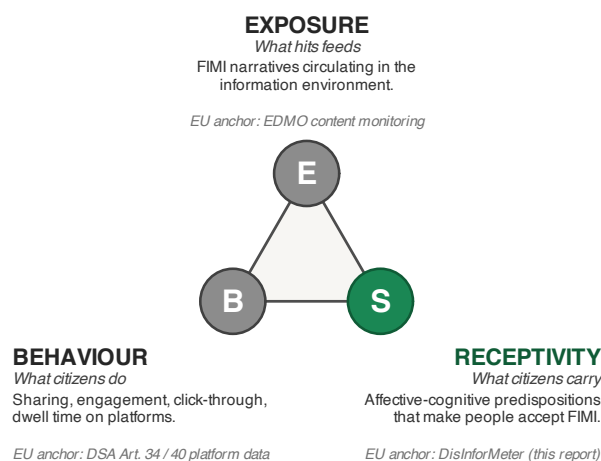
2. Why Audience Receptivity Needs Measuring

EU counter-FIMI infrastructure has become substantially stronger on the supply side. EEAS StratCom and the FIMI Defender framework track incidents, behaviours, and narratives. EDMO hubs and fact-checkers monitor claims and information ecosystems. The Digital Services Act creates obligations for very large online platforms and search engines to assess and mitigate systemic risks, including risks to civic discourse, electoral processes, and public security (EEAS 2024; EEAS 2025; EEAS 2026; European Commission 2026; European Parliament and Council of the European Union 2022).

These evidence streams are necessary but incomplete. Narrative monitoring shows what circulates. Platform transparency shows where content travels. Incident databases document campaigns and attribution. None of these alone shows whether the relevant public detects the manipulation, whether detection differs by source, or which receptivity-relevant domains should guide resilience work. That is the audience layer addressed by the DisInforMeter.

The three legs of the FIMI evidence chain

EU instruments already cover EXPOSURE (EDMO) and BEHAVIOUR (DSA platform data). The DisInforMeter closes the chain by measuring population RECEPTIVITY.



Conceptual framing of the FIMI evidence chain. EU instruments already cover EXPOSURE (EDMO) and BEHAVIOUR (DSA platform data); the DisInforMeter closes the chain by measuring population RECEPTIVITY

Figure 1: The audience-receptivity layer. DisInforMeter complements narrative monitoring and platform-behaviour evidence. It measures the population side of FIMI risk: detection, receptivity-relevant psychology, and civic anchors.

2.1 What a standard indicator enables

A standard population indicator enables five policy uses. First, it adds a demand-side baseline to narrative and incident monitoring. Second, it lets EDMO hubs, national regulators, and survey infrastructures field comparable items. Third, it helps DSA risk teams distinguish exposure from audience receptivity. Fourth, it connects FIMI work to civic attitudes such as institutional trust, EU support, political efficacy, and social trust. Fifth, it provides

a FIMI-specific baseline against which future media-literacy, prebunking, and resilience interventions can be evaluated (ESS 2024; Lewandowsky et al. 2017; Linden 2024; OECD 2017; Pennycook and Rand 2021).

Policy interpretation

Receptivity is treated here as a population-level signal. It should be read together with exposure, information-environment, and country-context evidence. High or low scores do not describe all citizens in a country and should never be used for individual-level targeting.

3. The DisInforMeter Instrument

The DisInforMeter is a layered survey instrument. On the predictor side, it measures affective-cognitive domains that theory and prior evidence link to openness to manipulative foreign-origin narratives. On the criterion side, it uses a FIMI headline battery. The headline battery is not a generic misinformation quiz: the S4 items are confirmed foreign-manipulation cases, scored as perceived manipulation by a foreign actor (Lewandowsky et al. 2017; Pennycook and Rand 2019; Pennycook and Rand 2021; Roozenbeek and Linden 2019; Roozenbeek et al. 2020).

How the DisInforMeter was built

A three-stage funnel: a systematic evidence review and multi-country expert consultation are distilled — 121 to 84 to 27 items — into a validated, deployment-ready instrument.



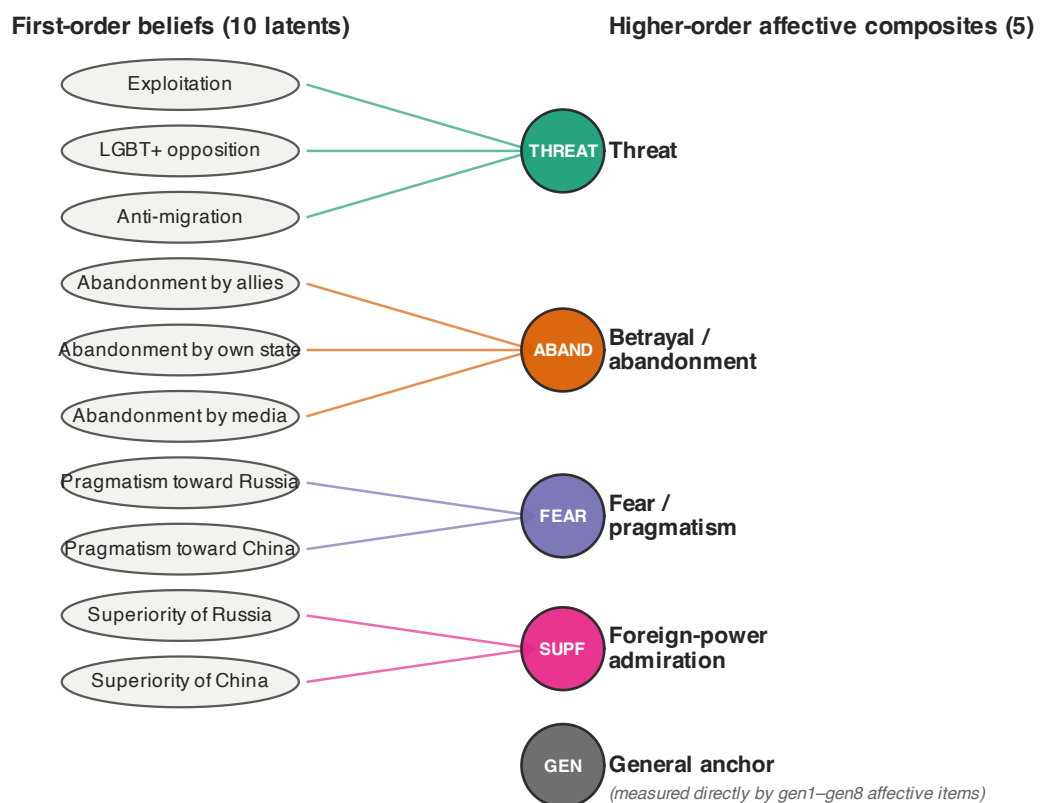
Construction pipeline of the DisInforMeter, read top to bottom. A systematic literature review (1,113 articles, 121 studies, 29 scales) and multi-country expert consultation (20+ interviews, 2 focus groups across BE, BG, LT, LV, TR) fed an item pool that was distilled from 121 to 84 to 27 items through expert feedback, factor analyses, and cross-cultural validation in 19 languages and 13 countries.

Figure 2: Construction funnel for the DisInforMeter. The instrument was built through a multi-stage process that combined conceptual sources, item-pool development, empirical refinement, cross-country comparability checks, and validation evidence.

The instrument was not assembled as a single questionnaire exercise. It was constructed through a staged evidence pipeline: conceptual work on FIMI receptivity and civic vulnerability, item generation and harmonisation across study waves, empirical scale refinement, cross-national measurement checks, and external validation against civic, media, and misinformation-related anchors. This design matters for policy use because the instrument combines substantive FIMI knowledge, psychometric selection, and deployment evidence rather than relying on face-valid item lists alone (Boateng et al. 2018; Clark and Watson 1995; Cronbach 1951; DeVellis 2017; McDonald 1999).

DisInforMeter architecture: 10 first-order beliefs → 5 affective composites

First-order belief constructs (latent ovals) feed four of the five higher-order affective composites. The General anchor (GEN) is measured directly by its own affective indicators (gen1–gen8) rather than by the first-order belief items. Arrows show construct membership only; standardised loadings are reported in the per-study CFA tables.



Architecture of the DisInforMeter. Left column: ten first-order belief constructs (latent ovals), grouped clockwise by parent composite (Threat → Betrayal → Fear → Foreign-power admiration). Right column: five higher-order affective composites measured directly in S2–S5. The General anchor (GEN) is measured by its own affective indicators rather than the first-order belief items; arrows therefore stop at the four composites with first-order children. Poisonous ethnocentrism is currently excluded from analyses and is not shown.

Figure 3: Five-domain DisInforMeter architecture. The instrument separates five receptivity-relevant domains from the FIMI criterion. This separation is central to interpretation: DisInforMeter domains indicate receptivity-relevant endorsement; S4 FIMI scores indicate detection of confirmed manipulation.

3.1 Construct architecture

The domain architecture links FIMI receptivity to established constructs in intergroup threat, institutional trust, political efficacy, populist attitudes, and misinformation discernment while keeping the FIMI detection criterion analytically separate from the receptivity domains (Akkerman et al. 2014; ESS 2024; Niemi et al. 1991; OECD 2017; Stephan et al. 2009).

Table 1: Policy-facing interpretation of the five DisInforMeter domains

Domain	What it captures	Policy use
Threat	Perceived threat to national identity, security, culture, sovereignty, or social order.	Identifies where FIMI may resonate through danger, loss, or value-erosion frames.
Betrayal/ Abandonment	Perceived failure of domestic institutions, allies, or mainstream information institutions to protect citizens.	Connects FIMI receptivity to institutional-trust, grievance, and civic-efficacy evidence.
Fear/Pragmatism	Anxiety-driven openness to accommodation with hostile or rival powers as a route to safety.	Helps separate fear-based accommodation narratives from admiration-based narratives.
Foreign-Power Admiration	Positive affect toward Russia, China, or alternative geopolitical models.	Flags affinity-based receptivity, especially where source identity matters.
General Anchor	Cross-cutting affective stance toward protection, external threats, and rival powers.	Provides a broad monitoring signal while preserving domain-level interpretation.

3.2 Short form and FIMI variants

The 27-item Short DisInforMeter is designed for deployment where questionnaire space is limited: omnibus surveys, EDMO country factsheets, national media-authority monitoring, and repeated public-opinion waves. It preserves the core five-domain architecture while reducing respondent burden. It should be used as a monitoring instrument. When a study needs diagnostic precision, intervention evaluation, or detailed domain-level modelling, the longer item pool remains preferable. The five- or eight-item global-anchor variants are not validated for policy use; they are primarily for psychometric and theoretical investigation. The final tool release will include clear guidance on which variants are validated for which use cases.

The primary outcome in this report is the full FIMI detection measure, based on the eight-item battery. Russian-origin, Chinese-origin, and short FIMI variants are used for source-specific interpretation and sensitivity analysis. The short FIMI detection subset is source-balanced. The source-specific variants should not be collapsed when the policy question is whether a public detects Russian-origin and Chinese-origin manipulation differently.

4. Evidence Base and Measurement Quality

The final tool validation rests on a five-study chain: initial scale generation (S1), replication and refinement (S2 and S3), multinational deployment (S4), and external-validation evidence (S5).

Five studies, two years, three populations

The DisInforMeter went from an initial Lithuanian item pool to a 13-country deployment plus an external-validity confirmation in 16 months. Each chip lists the study code; the N pill carries the sample size; the band above names the study's role.

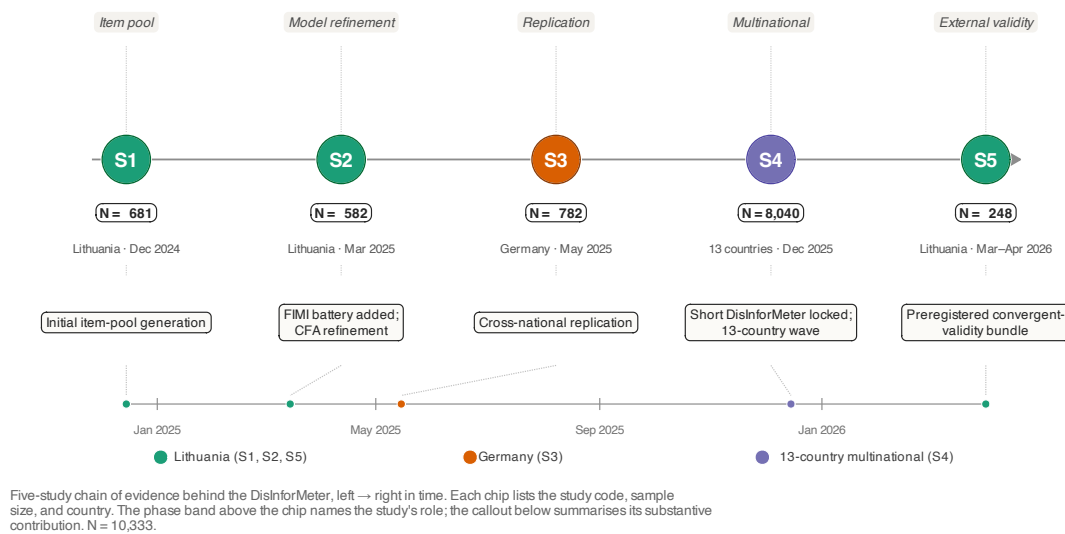


Figure 4: Five-study evidence chain. S1–S5 cover item-pool generation, model refinement, cross-national replication, multinational deployment, and external validation.

Table 2: Five-study evidence chain

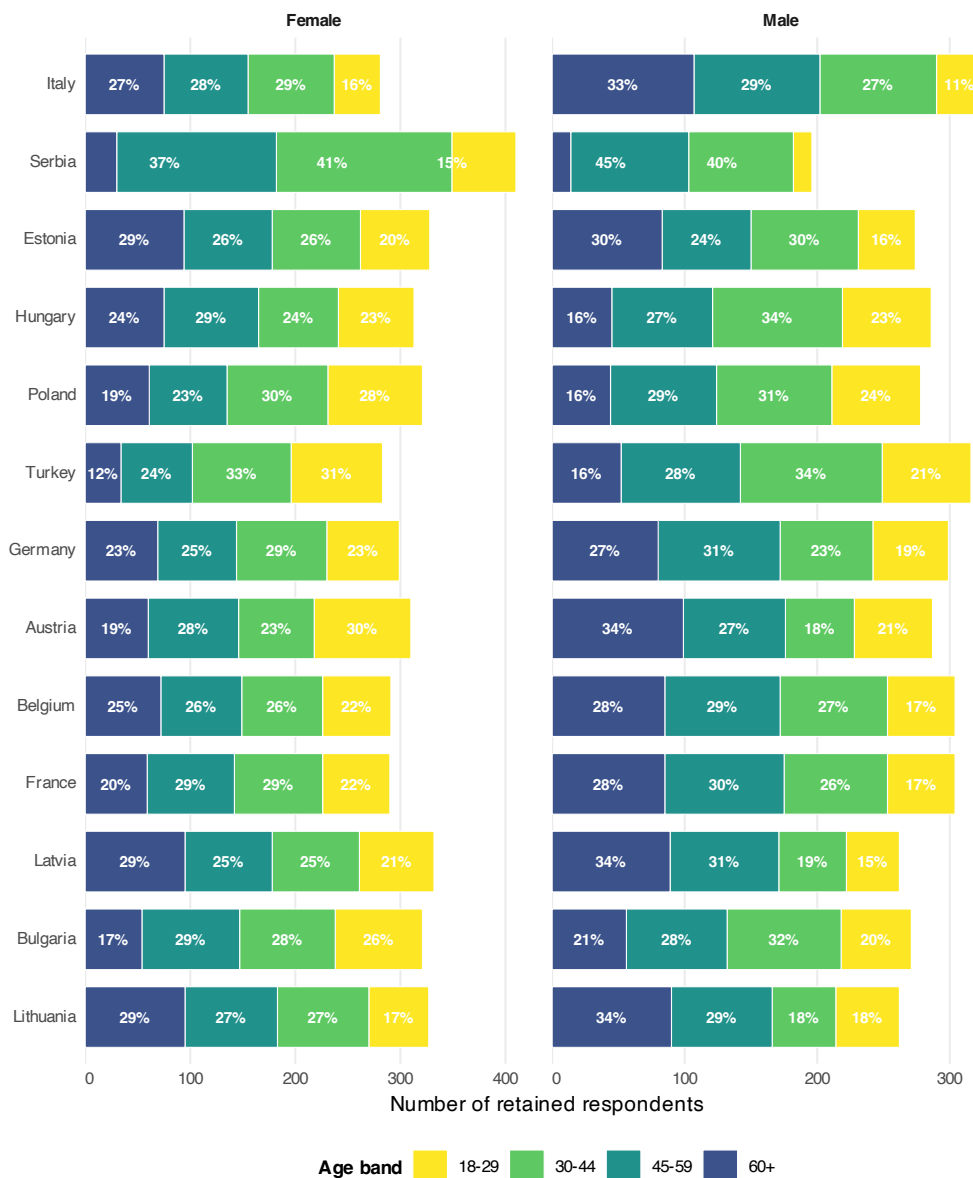
Study	Country / fielding	N	Main empirical role
S1	Lithuania, Dec 2024	681	Initial item-pool generation and scale construction; FIMI measured as sharing intent.
S2	Lithuania, Mar 2025	582	Model refinement and first full eight-item FIMI detection battery.
S3	Germany, May 2025	782	Cross-national replication of the S2 architecture.
S4	13 countries, Dec 2025	8,040 fielded; 7,783 in this report cut	Multinational deployment, country profiles, FIMI source variants, and invariance ladder.
S5	Lithuania, Mar–Apr 2026	248	External validation against preregistered civic, affective, and validation-scale anchors.

4.1 S4 country fielding

The main policy-report wave is Study 4 (S4). The original multinational fielding contains 8,040 respondents. The implemented policy-report figures use 7,783 in-scope observations across 13 countries after the current report cut and country eligibility decisions. The in-scope countries are Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Estonia, France, Germany, Hungary, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Poland, Serbia, and Turkey. The fielded countries, thus, capture four key regional clusters: Baltic (Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania), Central-East (Bulgaria, Hungary, Poland), Southern (Italy, Serbia, Turkey), and Western Europe (Austria, Belgium, France, Germany).

Who answered? S4 sample composition by country, age, and gender

Stacked counts within each gender panel; age bands ordered youngest → oldest. Percent labels appear inside segments accounting for ≥10 % of that country × gender cell. Other / prefer-not-to-say respondents: n = 13 across 6 countries (omitted from the bars).



S4 (2025), 13 countries. Bars show retained Female / Male respondents per country × age band. Country order: total retained N (largest at top). Female n = 4,106; Male n = 3,664. Other / prefer-not-to-say respondents (n = 13 across 6 countries) are omitted from the bars for legibility but are part of the retained sample (total N = 7,783). N = 7,783.

Figure 5: **S4 sample composition.** The report cut uses near-600 respondent country samples across 13 countries. Dense sample-composition detail is reported in Annex C.

4.2 Comparability and reliability

The measurement model is sufficiently stable for the main purposes of this policy report: comparing country profiles, examining differences between detection sources, and analysing relationships between constructs and FIMI. Tests of country-level comparability meet the standard threshold for metric invariance (using the conventional ΔCFI criterion), meaning that relationships and patterns can generally be compared across countries with confidence. Evidence for scalar invariance is more limited, which means that absolute comparisons of latent mean levels should be interpreted more cautiously (Chen 2007; Cheung and Rensvold 2002).

Reliability diagnostics across studies are generally strong for the core receptivity constructs. Median internal-consistency estimates across studies are high for betrayal / abandonment ($\alpha = .893$, $\omega = .894$), foreign-power admiration ($\alpha = .939$, $\omega = .941$), and Threat ($\alpha = .884$, $\omega = .886$), and acceptable for fear / pragmatism ($\alpha = .833$, $\omega = .836$). By conventional standards, values above approximately .70 are generally considered acceptable for group-level research, while values above .80 indicate strong reliability. Reliability for the broader General Anchor construct is more modest ($\alpha = .662$, $\omega = .708$), reflecting its intentionally heterogeneous and cross-domain nature; detailed coefficients and AVE estimates are reported in Annex C (Cronbach 1951; McDonald 1999).

In practice, this means the results are most robust when used to compare relative patterns, answering questions such as, which countries score higher or lower on a construct, how do FIMI receptivity profiles differ across contexts, or how do receptivity constructs relate to FIMI detection. Claims about precise differences in absolute latent scores are less certain and should be treated as indicative rather than definitive.

S4 multi-country invariance ladder

CFI drops as each invariance step adds constraints. Steeper drop = bigger constraint cost. $\Delta CFI \geq -0.005$ passes; ≥ -0.010 borderline; below that, fails.

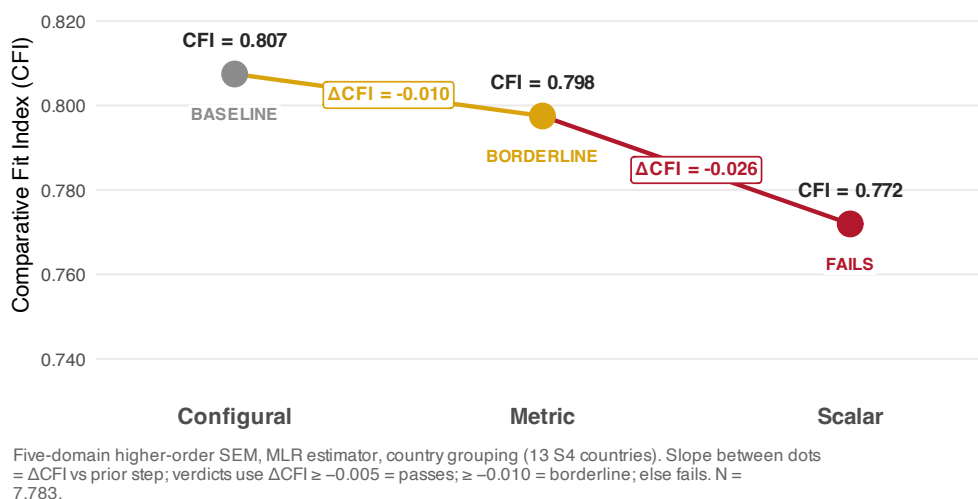
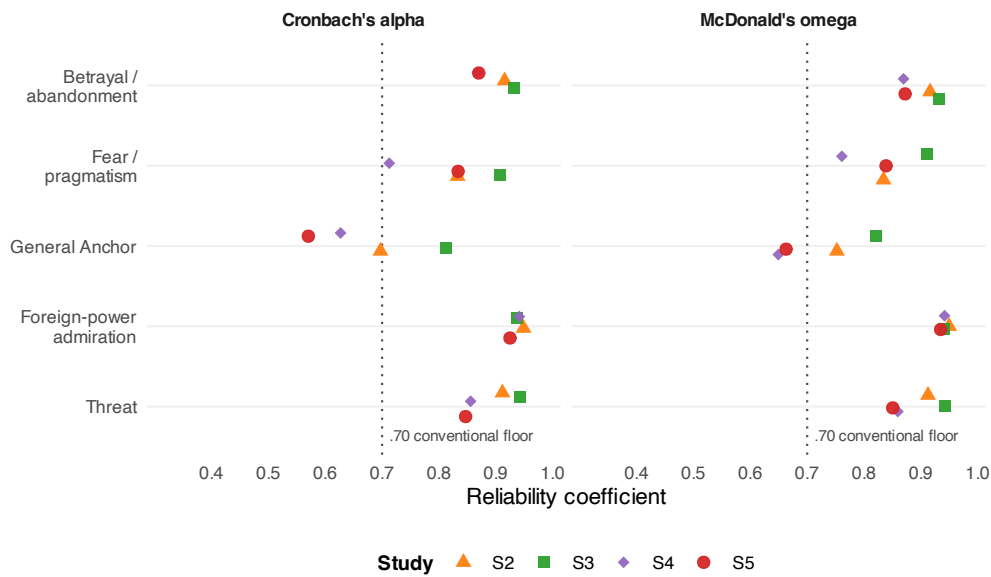


Figure 6: Measurement-comparability ladder. The S4 country-level ladder supports metric comparison and shows why scalar latent-mean claims are treated cautiously.

Internal consistency of higher-order constructs across studies

Values from the higher-order reliability repository; dotted line marks .70.



20 construct x study cells across S2--S5.

Figure 7: **Reliability evidence.** Reliability varies by construct and study. The main report uses the short form for policy monitoring and reserves detailed reliability and AVE evidence for Annex C.

Comparability caveat

Country comparisons in this report are strongest when read as profiles, ranks, and associations. Absolute latent-mean comparisons are included where implemented but should be reported with the scalar-invariance caveat.

5. Headline Findings

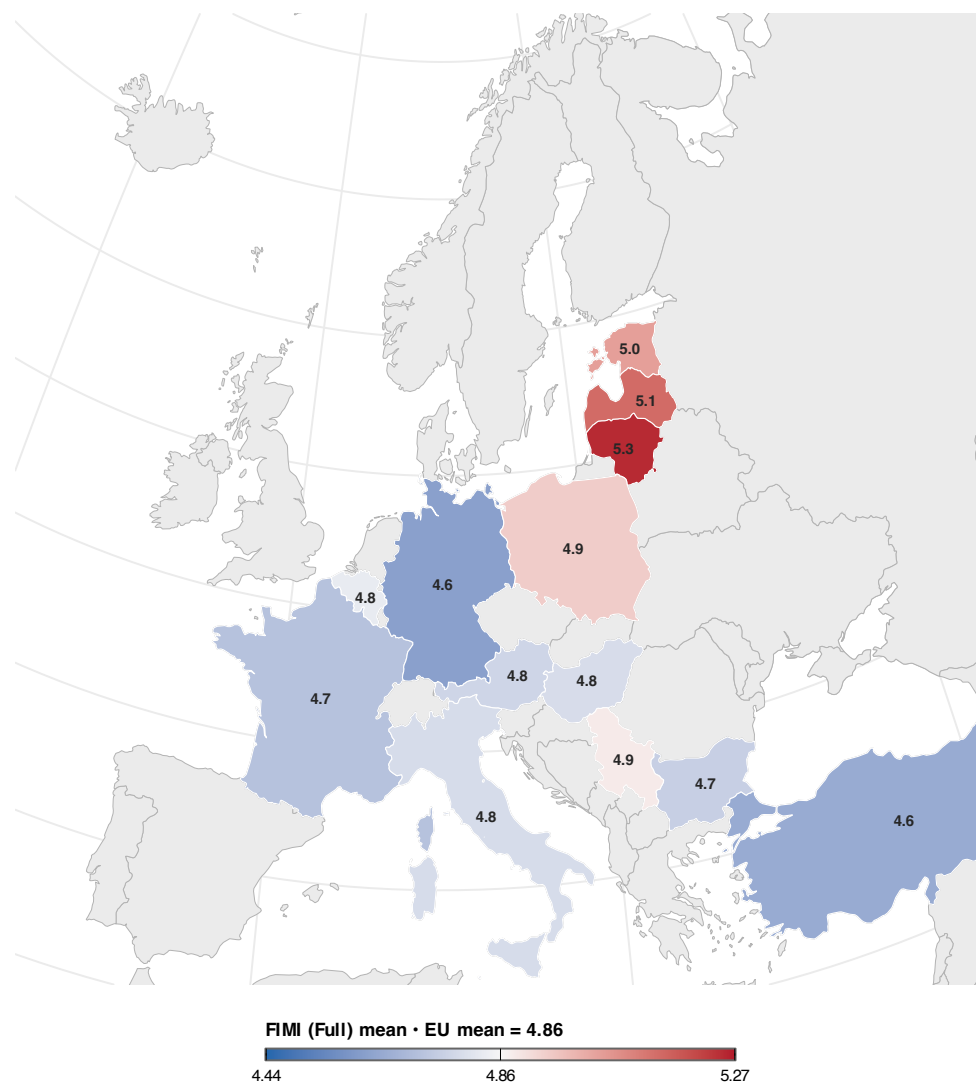
The headline findings cluster around three main aspects of measuring FIMI receptivity: (a) regional differences in the detection of FIMI cases (5.1, 5.2, and 5.3), (b) regional differences in FIMI receptivity (5.4, and 5.5), and (c) differences in receptivity–detection relationships (5.6).

5.1 Detection of confirmed FIMI cases varies across Europe

One headline finding is the comparative value of assessing FIMI detection as an audience-side signal. Higher values mean respondents more readily recognised the confirmed FIMI headlines as manipulated by a foreign actor. Lower values indicate a larger detection blind spot. We find a relatively wide range of detection means as well as regional cluster patterns. The Baltic cluster shows the highest FIMI detection: Lithuania (5.25), Latvia (5.14), and Estonia (5.04). Germany (4.62), Turkey (4.65), and France (4.71) show the lowest Full FIMI detection means in the current country set.

Detection of foreign-information manipulation across Europe (S4)

Country means on the 8-item FIMI battery (1–7, higher = better detection); pan-European mean = 4.86.



S4 (2025). FIMI Full operationalisation (news1–8). All eight items are confirmed FIMI cases; respondents rated each headline from 1 = 'certainly NOT manipulated' to 7 = 'certainly manipulated', so higher = better detection. Projection: ETRS89 / LAEA Europe (EPSG:3035). N = 7,783.

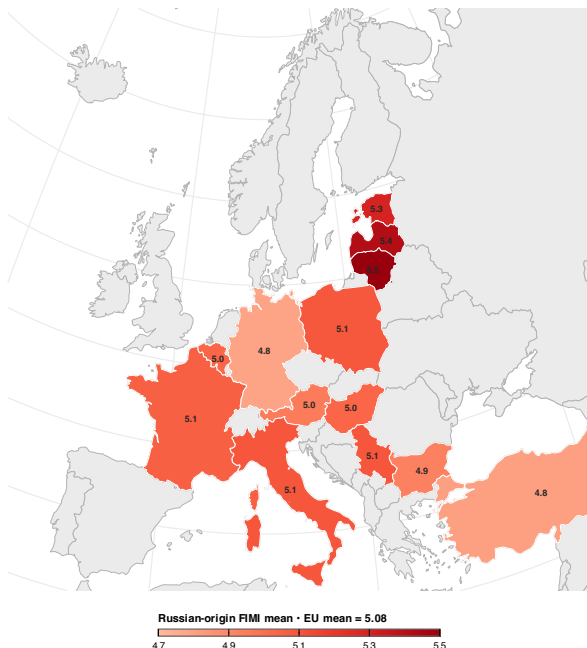
Figure 8: Full FIMI detection across S4 countries. Respondents rated confirmed FIMI items from 1 = certainly not manipulated to 7 = certainly manipulated. Higher country means indicate better detection.

5.2 In different regions Chinese-origin FIMI is detected less readily than Russian-origin FIMI

When looking at the FIMI source (Russian vs. Chinese actors) we find another key policy-relevant asymmetry. In all 13 countries, Russian-origin FIMI is detected more readily than Chinese-origin FIMI. The largest gap is in France (+0.92), followed by Italy (+0.82), Latvia (+0.74), Estonia (+0.70), and Hungary (+0.67). The smallest gap is in Poland (+0.39), but even there the confidence interval excludes zero. This does not show that Russian-origin FIMI is harmless; it shows that the specific Chinese-origin cases in the study's item bank are harder for respondents to flag.

Detection of Russian-origin foreign-information manipulation (S4)

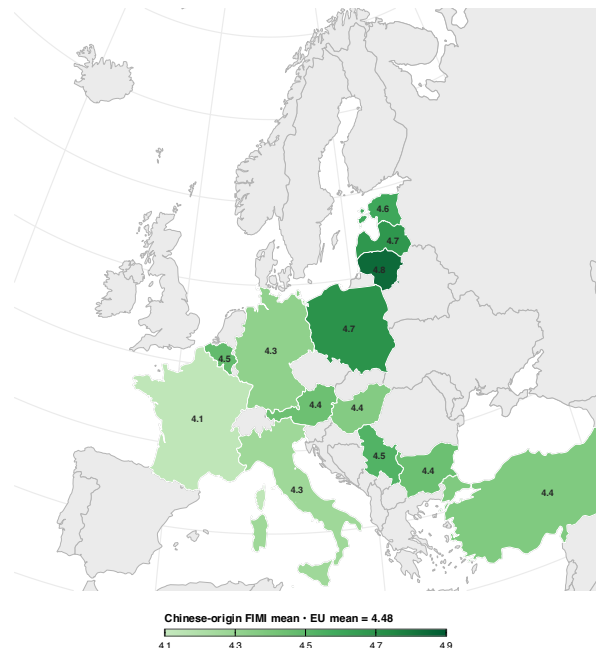
Country means on the 5-item Russian-origin FIMI subset (1–7, higher = better detection); pan-European mean = 5.08.



S4 (2025). FIMI Russian-origin variant (news1–5). All items confirmed FIMI cases; rating scale 1 = 'certainly NOT manipulated' to 7 = 'certainly manipulated'; so higher = better detection. Independent (sequential) colour scale. Projection: ETRS89 / LAEA Europe (EPSG:3035). N = 7,783.

Detection of Chinese-origin foreign-information manipulation (S4)

Country means on the 3-item Chinese-origin FIMI subset (1–7, higher = better detection); pan-European mean = 4.48.



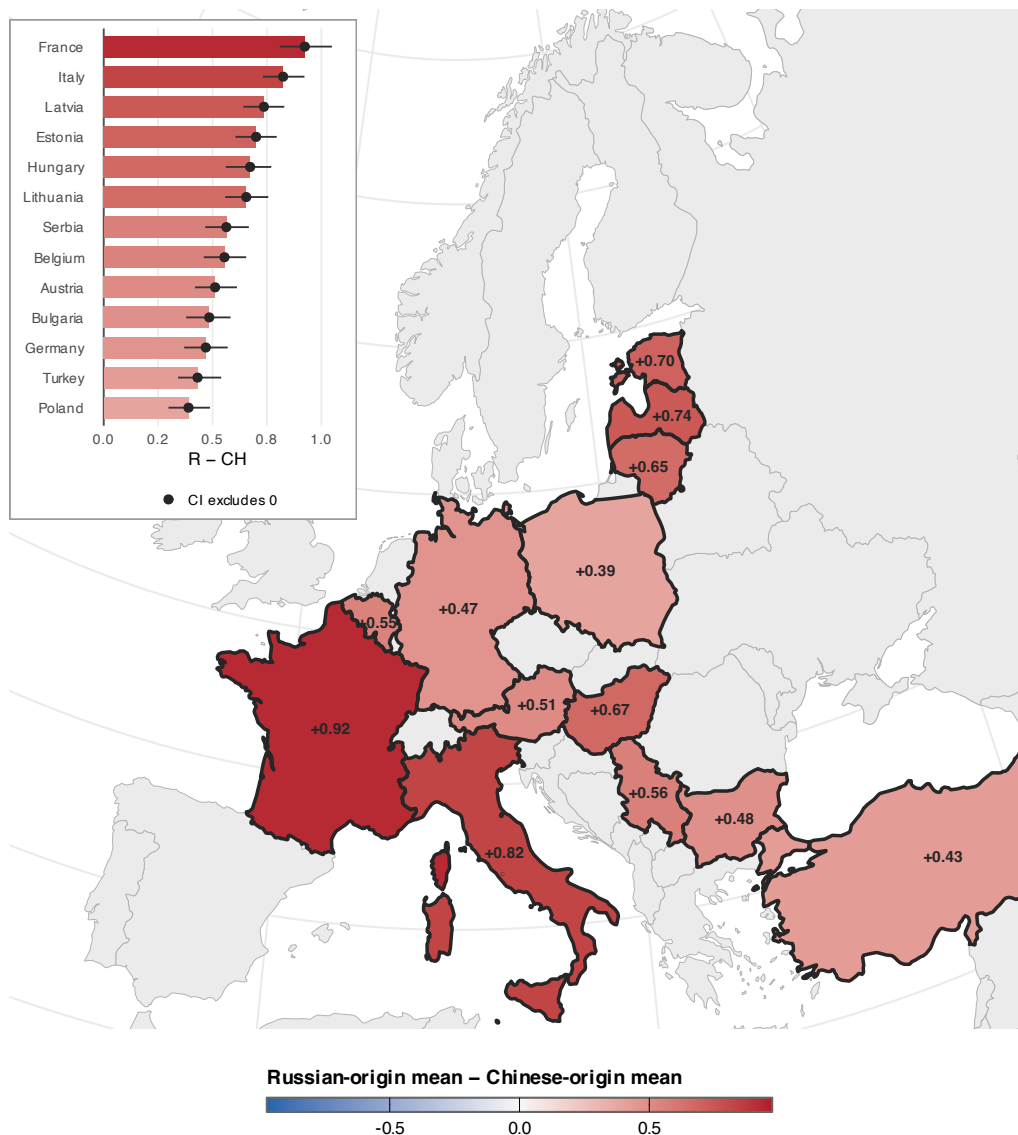
S4 (2025). FIMI Chinese-origin variant (news6–8). All items confirmed FIMI cases; rating scale 1 = 'certainly NOT manipulated' to 7 = 'certainly manipulated'; so higher = better detection. Independent (sequential) colour scale. Projection: ETRS89 / LAEA Europe (EPSG:3035). N = 7,783.

Figure 9: Russian-origin FIMI detection.
Russian-origin detection is generally higher than Chinese-origin detection in the same countries.

Figure 10: Chinese-origin FIMI detection.
Chinese-origin detection is the systematic blind spot in the implemented S4 item bank.

Where Russian-origin FIMI is detected more readily than Chinese-origin FIMI (S4)

Positive values = better at flagging Russian-origin manipulation than Chinese-origin manipulation.
Filled countries: CI excludes zero. Unfilled outlined countries: CI includes zero.



S4 (2025). All items confirmed FIMI cases; respondents rated each headline 1 = 'certainly NOT manipulated' to 7 = 'certainly manipulated', so higher = better detection. Plotted: per-country (Russian-origin - Chinese-origin) detection-score difference with 95% CIs (parametric, t-based). Positive values = respondents detect Russian-origin FIMI more readily than Chinese-origin FIMI. Heavy outline marks the 13 / 13 countries whose CI excludes zero. Projection: ETRS89 / LAEA Europe (EPSG:3035). N = 7,783.

Figure 11: Source-specific detection asymmetry. Positive values mean Russian-origin manipulation is detected more readily than Chinese-origin manipulation. All 13 confidence intervals exclude zero.

Source-specific caveat

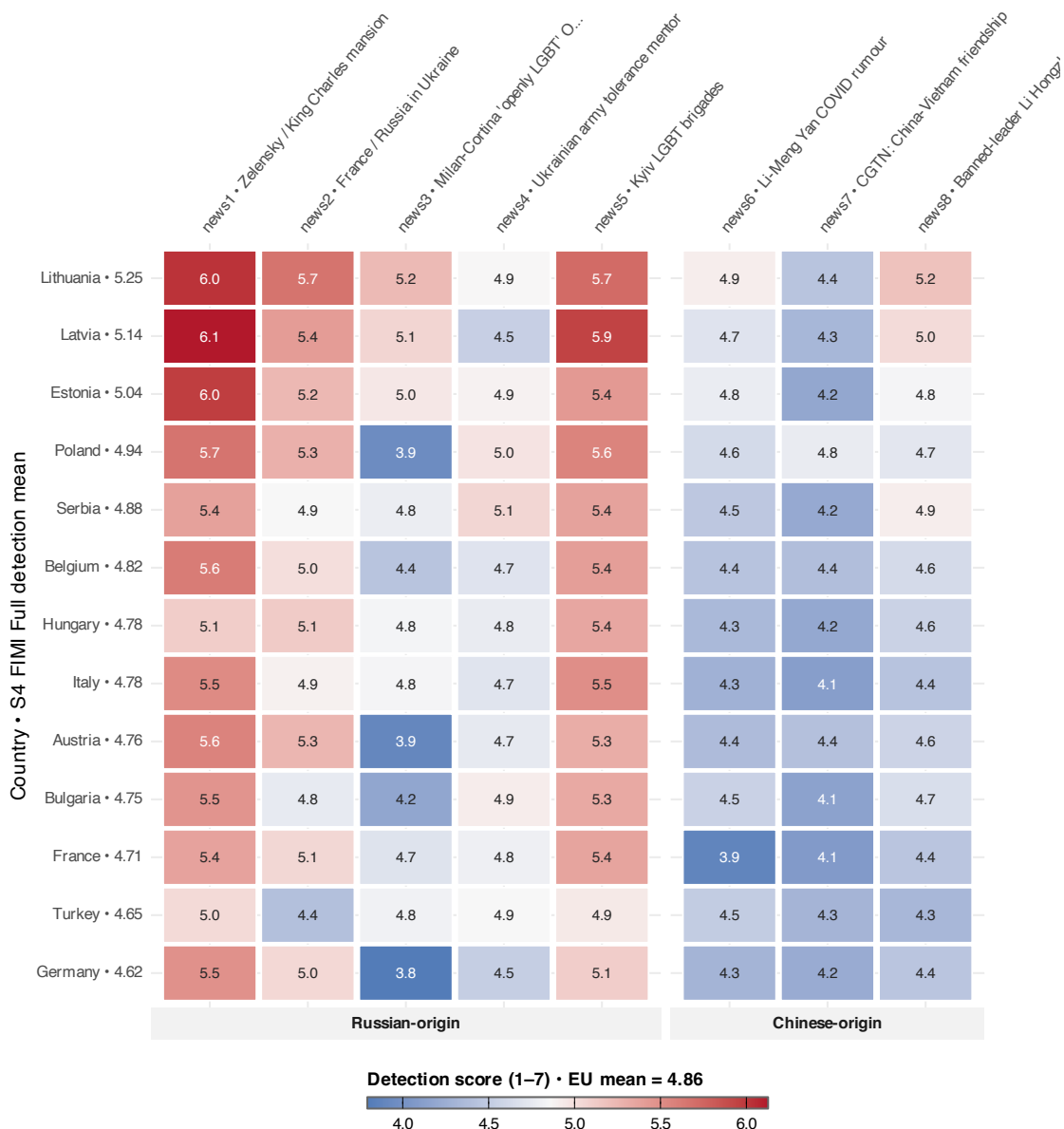
The source-specific result is bounded by the implemented item bank. It compares the Russian-origin and Chinese-origin cases included in the study. It should not be generalised to all Russian, Chinese, domestic, or other foreign-origin manipulation.

5.3 Individual FIMI events are detected more or less readily within different countries

When looking at the individual FIMI items, we find that while there is a general detection agreement across countries for some FIMI cases, some FIMI cases show strong regional blind spots. The country-by-item heatmap also shows why the source-specific gap should remain visible in policy reporting. The aggregate FIMI detection score is useful for headline monitoring, but item-level patterns identify which specific cases or source contexts require follow-up testing, translation review, or narrative monitoring.

Country × FIMI item detection (S4)

Cells show country-level mean detection score (1–7); higher = better at flagging that item as manipulated.



S4 (2025). All eight items are confirmed FIMI cases; respondents rated each headline from 1 = 'certainly NOT manipulated' to 7 = 'certainly manipulated', so higher = better detection. Rows ordered by overall S4 FIMI Full detection mean (right-most number); columns grouped by Russian then Chinese origin. Diverging palette centred on pan-European Full FIMI detection mean = 4.86. N = 7,783.

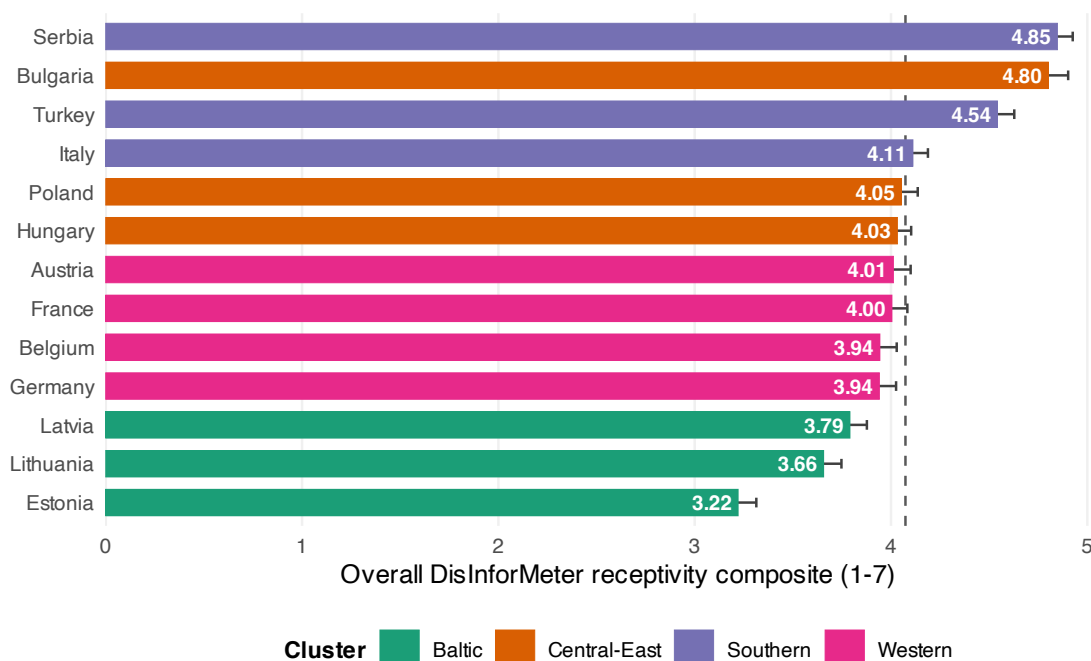
Figure 12: **Country-by-FIMI-item heatmap.** Item-level evidence is the diagnostic bridge between survey monitoring and narrative analysis.

5.4 Overall FIMI receptivity differs systematically across Europe

Moving from FIMI detection to the overall psycho-social FIMI receptivity (the DisInforMeter), we find strong regional differences across Europe. The overall DisInforMeter score averages the higher-order domains and is scored so that higher values indicate stronger receptivity-relevant endorsement. We find that the Baltic countries sit lowest on this composite — Estonia (3.22), Lithuania (3.66), and Latvia (3.79). While the Central-Eastern countries on average score the highest — Serbia (4.85), Bulgaria (4.80), and Turkey (4.54). This pattern should guide follow-up diagnosis; it is not a stand-alone risk ranking.

Where does each country sit on overall DisInforMeter receptivity? (S4)

Mean overall DisInforMeter composite per country (1 = lowest receptivity-relevant endorsement, 7 = highest). Whiskers show 95 % CI; vertical dashed reference is the pan-European pooled mean.



S4 (2025). Overall DisInforMeter composite = unweighted mean of the five higher-order domains (THREAT, ABAND, FEAR, GEN, ADMIR composite). Higher values indicate higher receptivity-relevant psychology, not better FIMI detection. Whiskers: 95 % CI of the country mean. Vertical reference = pan-European pooled mean (4.07). N = 7,783.

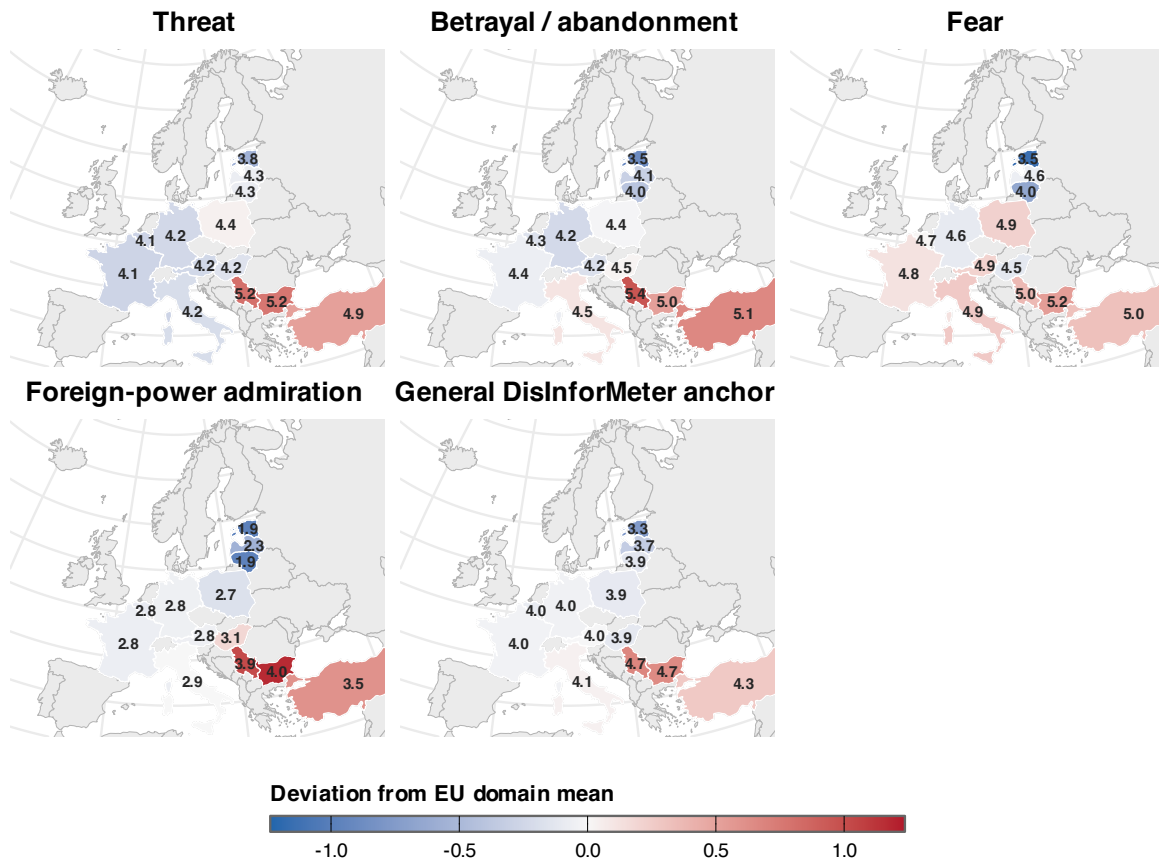
Figure 13: Overall DisInforMeter receptivity composite. Higher values indicate higher receptivity-relevant endorsement, not better FIMI detection. The dashed line is the pan-European pooled mean.

5.5 Some receptivity domains drive European differences more than others

The country-domain small multiples show that the same headline FIMI score can sit on different psychological profiles. For example, Serbia and Bulgaria are high across Threat, Betrayal/Abandonment, Fear/Pragmatism, and Foreign-Power Admiration, while the Baltic countries are lower on overall receptivity-relevant endorsement and especially low on Foreign-Power Admiration, while also showing high FIMI detection. Across most domains the Western countries cluster sits near the pooled mean on the overall composite but show source-specific detection blind spots.

Five-domain decomposition of DisInforMeter (S4)

Deviation from each domain's pan-European mean; cells annotated with absolute country mean (1–7).



S4 (2025). Five higher-order DisInforMeter domains; cells coloured by deviation from each domain's pan-European mean; in-panel labels show absolute means on the 1–7 scale. Projection: ETRS89 / LAEA Europe (EPSG:3035). N = 38,915.

Figure 14: Country variation across DisInforMeter domains. The domain maps prevent a one-dimensional reading of country risk. They show which construct families drive each country's profile.

5.6 Different receptivity domains drive different FIMI detections in different countries

The most policy-relevant result is not only that countries differ in overall detection or overall receptivity-relevant endorsement. It is that the same DisInforMeter domain can be associated with better detection in one FIMI context and weaker detection in another. In the results below, positive values mean better recognition that a headline was foreign manipulation; negative values mean a detection blind spot. These are cross-sectional associations, not causal effects (Shadish et al. 2002).

One possible pattern is that a domain is associated with better detection across countries and FIMI source contexts. In our data, respondents who were more wary of hostile foreign actors such as Russia or China were consistently better at detecting FIMI. This Fear/Pragmatism relationship appears for Full FIMI ($\beta = .22$, 95% CrI [.18, .27], Russian-origin FIMI $\beta = .24$, 95% CrI [.18, .29], and Chinese-origin FIMI $\beta = .21$, 95% CrI [.17, .24]).

Another pattern is source reversal. Threat is associated with better detection of Russian-origin FIMI but worse detection of Chinese-origin FIMI. Betrayal/Abandonment shows the opposite pattern: it is associated with weaker Russian-origin detection but stronger Chinese-origin detection. Foreign-Power Admiration also changes meaning by source context: it is most clearly linked to poorer Russian-origin detection, while its Chinese-origin pattern is weaker and less uniform.

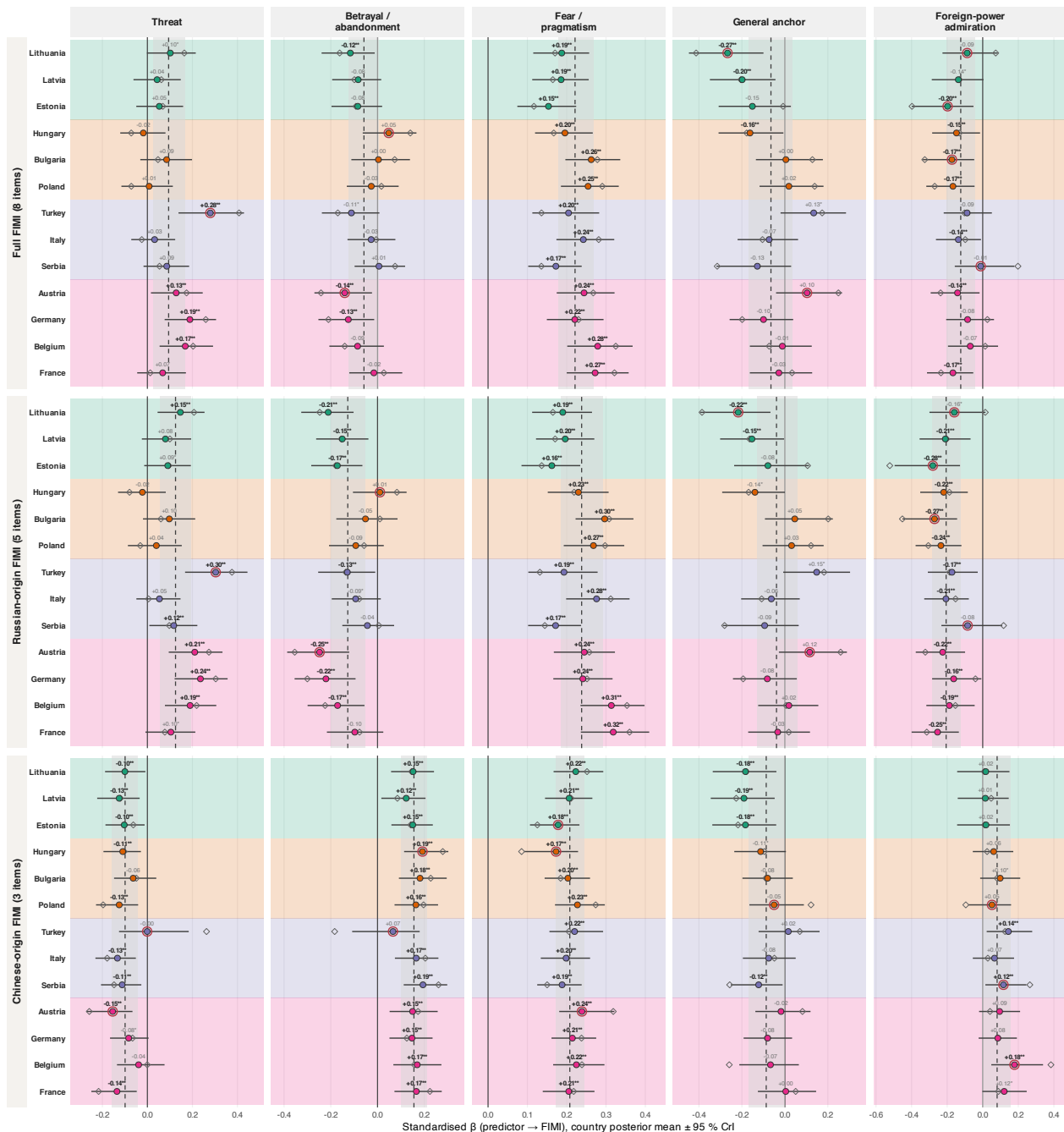
And lastly in some cases a domain can be a risk factor in one country while being a protective factor in another country. As an example, the General Anchor can be negatively associated with detection in some countries, including Lithuania, Latvia, Hungary, and Serbia depending on the FIMI variant, but positive for Russian-origin FIMI in Turkey and Austria (albeit a lot weaker). This is why the DisInforMeter should be read as a domain profile, not as one undifferentiated receptivity index.

Policy reading

Do not collapse these paths into a single "FIMI vulnerability" score. The same public attitude can be associated with better detection for one source context and worse detection for another. Monitoring, prebunking, and media-literacy work should therefore report at least three layers together: the country's domain profile, Full FIMI detection, and source-specific detection paths.

Country-by-country partial-pooled paths to FIMI — by FIMI operationalisation

Bayesian multilevel model (08b) repeated for three FIMI DVs: Full / Russian-origin / Chinese-origin. Each column has its own x-axis so per-predictor effect sizes are visible; rows share x within a column so cross-DV stability of a country's path is readable down the column. Filled dot = posterior mean (95 % CrI whisker, cluster-coloured); hollow diamond = per-country OLS reference (the partial-pooling target); dashed line = EU pooled posterior mean; grey band = pooled 95 % CrI; red ring = OLS estimate outside pooled P95.



Robustness across FIMI operationalisations. Each row applies the same Bayesian multilevel pipeline (08b) with a different FIMI DV (Full / Russian-origin / Chinese-origin). Filled dot = posterior mean; whisker = 95 % CrI. Numeric label above each dot: posterior β with * = 95 % CrI excludes 0, * = 90 % CrI excludes 0, 110 of 195 cells credible at 95 %; 29 cells flagged as candidates for prior-misspecification scrutiny (OLS estimate outside pooled P95). Within a column (predictor), the three rows share the same x-axis so country-level cross-DV stability can be read directly. N = 195.

Figure 15: Country predictor paths by FIMI operationalisation. Country estimates for Full, Russian-origin, and Chinese-origin FIMI detection. Positive coefficients indicate better detection; negative coefficients indicate a detection blind spot. The figure shows why source-specific detection paths should not be collapsed into a single score.

6. Conceptual Embeddedness and Validation

This section asks whether the DisInforMeter sits where it should sit conceptually. Civic anchors show how the domains connect to policy-relevant attitudes already monitored in democracy and resilience work. External validation then checks whether the same domains behave as expected against independent validation measures (Campbell and Fiske 1959; Cronbach and Meehl 1955).

6.1 Civic anchors

The civic-anchor evidence answers a policy-facing question: do DisInforMeter domains connect to the wider civic conditions that make FIMI resilience stronger or weaker? Betrayal/Abandonment is the clearest institutional-trust construct: it is associated with lower institutional trust, external political efficacy, EU support, social trust, and life satisfaction, and with higher perceived foreign-actor salience and perceived misinformation creators. Threat is also linked to lower institutional trust and EU support, while Fear/Pragmatism is more closely tied to perceived misinformation impact and responsibility for prevention. These are associations, but they show that the instrument speaks to the same civic conditions that EU institutions already monitor (Akkerman et al. 2014; ESS 2024; Niemi et al. 1991; OECD 2017; Reeskens and Hooghe 2008).

Nomological correlation network (S4 u S5)

DisInforMeter constructs (higher-order, indigo; lower-order, purple) embedded with S4 civic anchors (orange) and S5 validation scales (green). Positive correlations attract; negative correlations repel. Edge colour and width encode sign and strength of Pearson r .

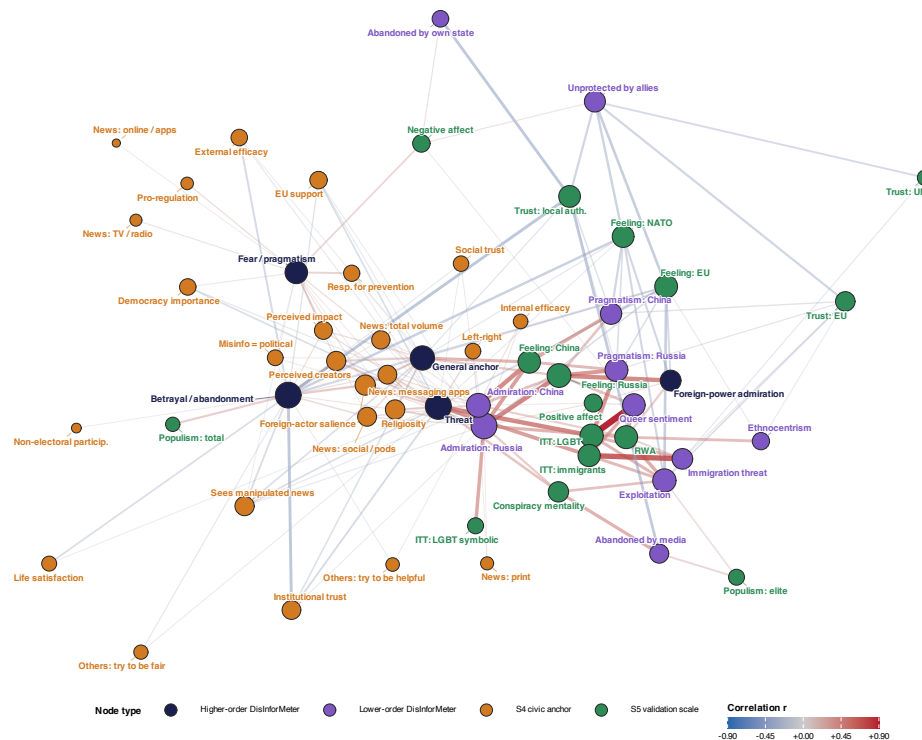


Figure 16: Nomological network overview. The network is an interpretive aid for the same anchor field shown in the heatmap. The heatmap remains the primary audit-friendly evidence figure.

Civic anchors x DisInforMeter constructs (S4)

Cell labels show pooled Pearson r ; '*' marks correlations that survive FDR ($p_{\text{fdr}} < .05$).
Diverging palette centred on zero. Rows: civic anchors, sorted by mean $|r|$ (strongest at top).



S4 (2025). Pooled Pearson r between civic anchors (rows) and DisInforMeter higher-order constructs (columns). * = survives FDR ($p_{\text{fdr}} < .05$); 156 of 174 cells are starred. Rows sorted by mean $|r|$ (largest at top); columns by row mean (most positively associated on the right). $N = 174$.

Figure 17: DisInforMeter domains and civic anchors. Rows are civic and misinformation anchors; columns are DisInforMeter domains. Cell labels are pooled Pearson correlations; stars indicate FDR-adjusted significance.

6.2 External validation

External validation asks a stricter measurement question: do the domains align with independent constructs they should theoretically resemble, while staying distinct from constructs they should not simply duplicate? Study 5 (S5) provides an external-validity wave in which every DisInforMeter construct is correlated against a battery of established scales. Three patterns stand out. First, the strongest correlations fall exactly where theory predicts: opposition to LGBT+ rights tracks the matching intergroup-threat measure almost

one-to-one ($r = .90$), anti-migration tracks intergroup threat from immigrants ($r = .75$), and foreign-power admiration tracks warmth toward Russia and China ($r \approx .6-.7$), and does so with the correct target, as Russia-directed items align more closely with the Russia feeling thermometer and China-directed items with the China thermometer. Second, the construct families separate cleanly rather than collapsing onto a single dimension: betrayal/abandonment is the institutional-distrust and populism construct (correlating around $-.4$ with institutional trust), whereas the threat constructs are largely unrelated to trust, a double dissociation that no undifferentiated negativity factor could produce. Third, associations with generic conspiracy mentality are only moderate and uniform (around $.3$), and admiration raises warmth toward Russia and China while lowering it toward the EU and NATO; the instrument is therefore neither a conspiracy scale nor a blanket negative-affect halo. Taken together, these convergent and discriminant patterns give the domains a clear, theory-consistent place in the wider nomological network (Bruder et al. 2013; Campbell and Fiske 1959; Imhoff and Bruder 2014; Stephan et al. 2009).

DisInforMeter constructs × external validation scales (S5)

Every pairwise Pearson correlation; strong associations cluster where theory predicts (convergent blocks), staying weak elsewhere (discriminant). Cell labels show r .

		Conspiracy & populism		Institutional trust			Intergroup threat & authoritarianism			Foreign-power feeling thermometers			
		Conspiracy mentality (CMQ)	Populist attitudes	Trust: local authorities	Trust: EU	Trust: UN	Right-wing authoritarianism	Intergroup threat: LGBT	Intergroup threat: immigrants	Feeling thermometer: Russia	Feeling thermometer: China	Feeling thermometer: EU	Feeling thermometer: NATO
Threat	Threat (general)	+0.37	+0.08	-0.15	-0.24	-0.12	+0.54	+0.62	+0.54	+0.22	+0.13	-0.27	-0.15
	Exploitation	+0.38	+0.12	-0.16	-0.25	-0.16	+0.49	+0.43	+0.42	+0.14	+0.08	-0.38	-0.30
	LGBT+ opposition	+0.27	-0.11	-0.00	-0.13	-0.00	+0.51	+0.90	+0.46	+0.38	+0.25	-0.22	-0.06
	Anti-migration	+0.16	-0.17	+0.02	-0.16	-0.07	+0.29	+0.43	+0.75	+0.04	+0.00	-0.13	+0.01
	Ethnocentrism	+0.28	+0.09	-0.03	-0.14	-0.09	+0.40	+0.44	+0.44	+0.08	+0.04	-0.15	-0.06
Betrayal/abandonment	Abandonment (general)	+0.40	+0.31	-0.42	-0.24	-0.26	+0.25	+0.24	+0.13	+0.24	+0.29	-0.31	-0.35
	Unprotected by allies	+0.38	+0.22	-0.32	-0.32	-0.27	+0.09	+0.20	+0.26	+0.07	+0.13	-0.37	-0.34
	Abandoned by own state	+0.33	+0.28	-0.41	-0.26	-0.23	+0.19	+0.18	+0.18	+0.23	+0.23	-0.40	-0.34
	Abandoned by media	+0.45	+0.20	-0.40	-0.33	-0.25	+0.39	+0.36	+0.19	+0.31	+0.30	-0.47	-0.40
Fear/pragmatism	Fear (general)	+0.29	+0.22	-0.07	-0.09	+0.01	+0.20	+0.12	+0.09	+0.12	+0.01	-0.06	-0.13
	Pragmatism toward Russia	+0.38	+0.05	-0.19	-0.18	-0.06	+0.48	+0.58	+0.18	+0.56	+0.41	-0.24	-0.24
	Pragmatism toward China	+0.45	+0.09	-0.21	-0.20	-0.12	+0.46	+0.57	+0.26	+0.37	+0.48	-0.34	-0.32
Foreign-power admiration	Admiration (general)	+0.33	+0.10	-0.27	-0.21	-0.23	+0.31	+0.47	+0.01	+0.62	+0.70	-0.28	-0.30
	Superiority of Russia	+0.32	+0.05	-0.15	-0.16	-0.07	+0.45	+0.54	+0.13	+0.64	+0.54	-0.24	-0.22
	Superiority of China	+0.31	+0.11	-0.17	-0.18	-0.21	+0.31	+0.41	+0.12	+0.39	+0.62	-0.19	-0.22
General	General DisInforMeter anchor	+0.28	+0.22	-0.18	-0.11	-0.04	+0.19	+0.23	-0.04	+0.34	+0.44	-0.13	-0.17

S5 (Lithuania, external-validity wave). Each cell is the pairwise Pearson correlation between a DisInforMeter construct (row) and an independent validation scale (column); blue = negative, red = positive. Constructs are grouped by higher-order family and scales by anchor family, so convergent correlations cluster into blocks. Pairwise-complete N ranges 247-248. Preregistered convergent/discriminant verdicts are reported in the academic manuscript. N = 248.

Figure 18: S5 external-validation correlation matrix. Each cell is the pairwise Pearson correlation between a DisInforMeter construct (row) and an independent validation scale (column); blue is negative, red positive. Constructs are grouped by higher-order family and scales by anchor family, so convergent associations form visible blocks while discriminant pairs stay pale.

7. Country Profiles for Policy Use

Country profiles translate the headline findings into a practical diagnostic view. They show where each country sits on detection, which FIMI source is harder to detect, and which receptivity domains are most aligned with detection or blind spots.

The report uses a single country-snapshot grid rather than one body page per country. Each card should be read top to bottom: overall FIMI detection versus the EU mean; Russian- and Chinese-origin variants; the strongest alignment with detection; the main blind-spot signal; and whether the pattern differs by source.

Three policy readings follow from the grid. First, the Baltic countries combine high FIMI detection with low receptivity-relevant endorsement, but they still show source-specific gaps. This makes them a useful baseline for frontline monitoring rather than a reason to stop monitoring. Second, Western countries are often near the overall DisInforMeter mean but show weaker Full FIMI detection, especially for Chinese-origin cases. Third, Serbia, Bulgaria, and Turkey have the highest receptivity-relevant endorsement profiles, but their dominant alignments differ; Turkey is particularly distinctive because Threat is the leading positive alignment with detection.

How to use country profiles

Country cards are prioritisation devices. They should trigger country-specific qualitative review, narrative-exposure analysis, and repeat measurement. They should not be quoted as league tables without the scoring, uncertainty, and invariance caveats.

Read each card top-to-bottom: where the country sits on FIMI detection vs the EU mean (with Russian- and Chinese-origin variants as flanking triangles), the strongest protective factor (positive predictor of detection) and Δ risk factor (negative predictor — blind spot), and whether the picture is consistent across the two source variants.

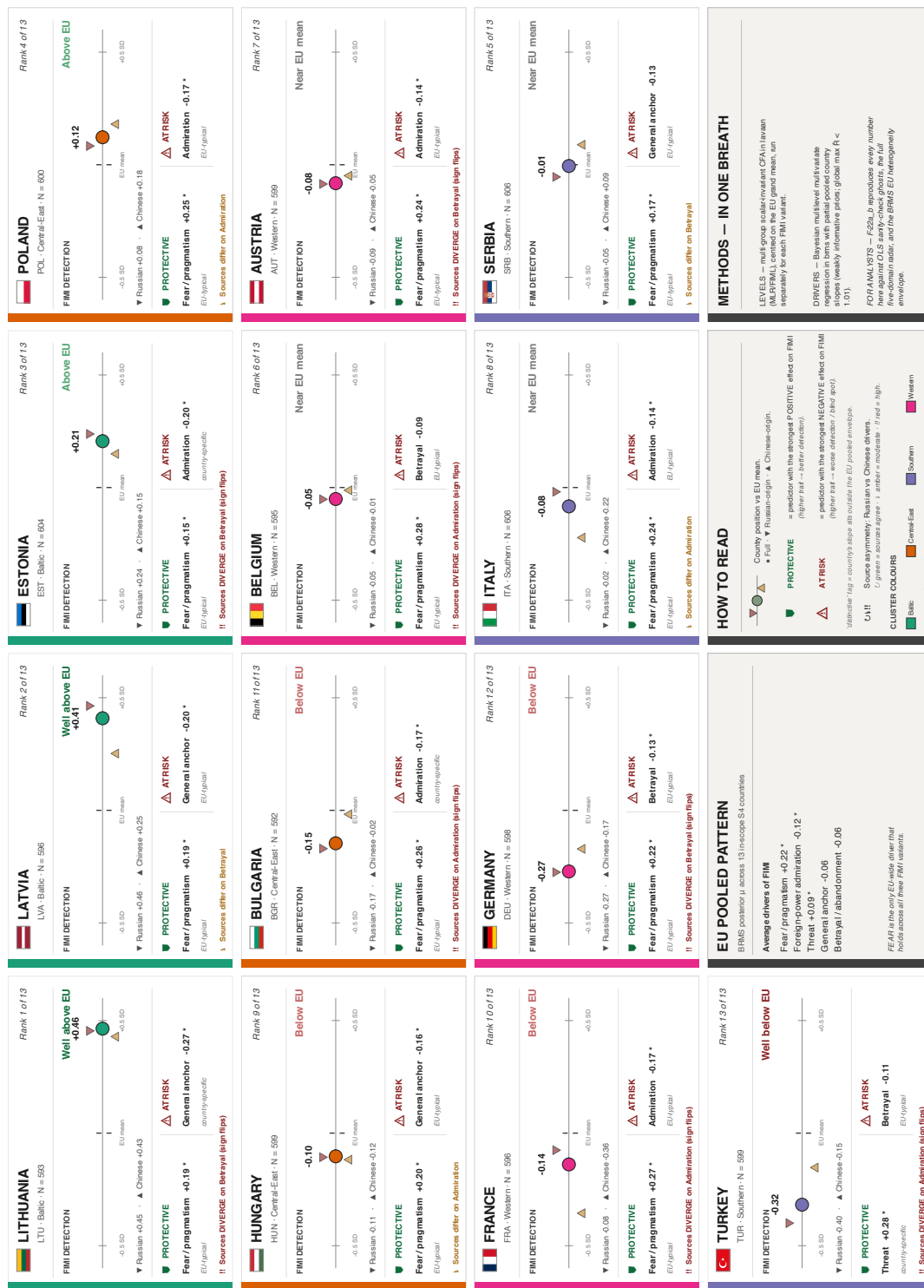


Figure 19: **Country snapshots.** One card per country: overall detection, source-specific detection, strongest alignment, and blind-spot signal.

8. Policy Applications

8.1 DG CONNECT and DSA risk assessments

For DSA risk assessment, the DisInforMeter adds a population denominator to platform evidence. Platform data can show reach, targeting, recommendation, and engagement. DisInforMeter data can show whether exposed populations also display low detection or high receptivity-relevant endorsement. The strongest use case is joint analysis: platform exposure by narrative/source crossed with country-level or subgroup-level DisInforMeter scores, reported only in aggregate and with privacy-preserving safeguards (European Commission 2022; European Commission 2025; European Parliament and Council of the European Union 2022).

8.2 EEAS StratCom and FIMI Defender

For EEAS StratCom, the source-specific FIMI result is directly actionable. Russian-origin and Chinese-origin detection should be monitored separately because the multinational data show a systematic Chinese-origin detection blind spot in the implemented item bank. The country cards help identify where a narrative monitoring cell should look for fear-based, threat-based, admiration-based, or abandonment-based resonance (EEAS 2024; EEAS 2025; EEAS 2026).

8.3 EDMO and national authorities

For EDMO hubs and national media authorities, the Short DisInforMeter can standardise the survey layer in country factsheets. A minimal recurring module should include the 27-item Short DisInforMeter, the eight-item FIMI battery or a refreshed equivalent, source labels, and the core civic anchors needed for interpretation. Reports should show confidence intervals and scoring direction on the same page as rankings (European Commission 2026).

8.4 ERGA, media literacy, and civil society

For regulators and civil-society partners, the instrument can improve programme evaluation. A media-literacy intervention may increase detection without changing deep receptivity-relevant domains, or it may shift one domain without shifting detection. The separation between DisInforMeter domains and the FIMI criterion makes that distinction measurable (ERGA 2020; Linden 2024; Roozenbeek and Linden 2019; Roozenbeek et al. 2020).

9. Recommendations

1. Establish a recurring population indicator

Add the 27-item Short DisInforMeter and the source-balanced FIMI criterion to regular country monitoring. Report domain profiles, Full FIMI detection, Russian-origin detection, Chinese-origin detection, and uncertainty intervals as a standard dashboard.

2. Report detection and receptivity separately

Keep the Full FIMI detection score distinct from the overall DisInforMeter receptivity-relevant composite. A country can be high on detection and low on receptivity, or near the mean on one and distinctive on the other. Collapsing the two would remove the main policy value of the instrument.

3. Treat source-specific blind spots as a monitoring priority

Require separate reporting of Russian-origin and Chinese-origin FIMI detection when item banks include both. The initial fielding evidence shows that source asymmetry is not a minor robustness detail; it is a headline result.

4. Use country profiles to target follow-up evidence, not to rank countries

Country cards should guide where to request platform data, where to refresh narrative item banks, where to run qualitative follow-up, and where to test interventions. Avoid public communication that converts country profiles into simplistic league tables.

5. Build an open, reusable evidence package

Publish the instrument, translations, scoring scripts, figure code, and caveat language. Use DOI-stamped releases for reproducibility. Release participant-level data where consent, anonymisation, and data-protection conditions permit (Wilkinson et al. 2016).

10. Limitations and Road Ahead

10.1 Current limitations

The report has five main limitations. First, all data is cross-sectional, so it cannot identify causal effects or trends. Second, the country set is broad but incomplete: several Member States are not covered. Third, the cross-national metric invariance supports relationship and profile comparisons, but scalar invariance is weaker, so absolute latent means require caveats. Fourth, the FIMI source-specific result is specific to the implemented Russian-origin and Chinese-origin cases. Fifth, survey indicators should be combined with platform, incident, and narrative data before operational prioritisation (Chen 2007; Cheung and Rensvold 2002; Shadish et al. 2002).

10.2 Next measurement priorities

The next phase should prioritise longitudinal measurement, expanded country coverage, refreshed source-specific FIMI item banks, and integration with DSA Article 40 research workflows. Methodologically, the key tasks are to stabilise scalar comparability, evaluate weighting and sampling adjustments, refresh translations, and test whether domain changes predict later changes in FIMI detection (European Commission 2025; European Parliament and Council of the European Union 2022).

Minimum caveat language for reuse

If DisInforMeter figures are reused outside this report, they should carry three statements: (1) FIMI figures show detection of confirmed FIMI cases, where higher means better detection; (2) DisInforMeter domain scores show receptivity-relevant endorsement, where higher means more endorsement; (3) country comparisons are population-level signals and do not license individual profiling.

A. Annex A: Evidence Chain and Instrument Summary

All data preparation and analysis steps, the full measured item bank, the recommended short form for future waves, in-detail country profiles, the complete nomological network, full measurement diagnostics, and the reproducible annotated code are available as part of the online supplemental material:

<https://thedataflowcompany.github.io/disinformeter-policy-report-supplement/>

B. Annex B: S4 Sample Composition

Table 3: S4 in-scope country samples

Country	Cluster	N	Mean age	Female	Tertiary education
Austria	Western	599	45.6	51.8%	28.2%
Belgium	Western	595	46.4	48.9%	45.0%
Bulgaria	Central-East	592	43.8	54.2%	44.8%
Germany	Western	598	45.8	50.0%	36.6%
Estonia	Baltic	604	47.1	54.3%	37.1%
France	Western	596	46.0	48.7%	40.8%
Hungary	Central-East	599	44.0	52.3%	23.9%
Italy	Southern	606	48.6	46.4%	36.0%
Lithuania	Baltic	593	48.1	55.1%	50.1%
Latvia	Baltic	596	47.9	55.7%	38.3%
Poland	Central-East	600	42.6	53.5%	31.5%
Serbia	Southern	606	43.5	67.7%	52.6%
Turkey	Southern	599	41.8	47.2%	56.1%

N = 7,783.

c. Annex C: Measurement and FIMI Diagnostics

Table 4: Selected reliability diagnostics used in the report

Study	Construct	Items	α	ω	AVE
S2	Betrayal / abandonment	8	.915	.916	.576
S3	Betrayal / abandonment	8	.932	.932	.613
S4	Betrayal / abandonment	6	.868	.869	.527
S5	Betrayal / abandonment	8	.870	.872	.462
S2	Fear / pragmatism	6	.833	.834	.437
S3	Fear / pragmatism	6	.908	.910	.580
S4	Fear / pragmatism	3	.713	.761	.539
S5	Fear / pragmatism	6	.834	.839	.430
S2	General Anchor	8	.697	.752	.218
S3	General Anchor	8	.813	.822	.375
S4	General Anchor	5	.627	.649	.267
S5	General Anchor	8	.570	.663	.278
S2	Foreign-power admiration	8	.949	.950	.700
S3	Foreign-power admiration	8	.938	.941	.660
S4	Foreign-power admiration	6	.941	.942	.713
S5	Foreign-power admiration	8	.925	.935	.634
S2	Threat	12	.912	.912	.428
S3	Threat	12	.942	.942	.575
S4	Threat	7	.856	.859	.464
S5	Threat	12	.847	.850	.312

Median α/ω across S2–S5: Betrayal / abandonment .893/.894; Fear / pragmatism .833/.836; General Anchor .662/.708; Foreign-power admiration .939/.941; Threat .884/.886. AVE = average variance extracted.

Table 5: Measurement-invariance summary for policy interpretation

Ladder	Step	CFI	RMSEA	Δ CFI	Δ RMSEA	Policy reading
S4 country-level, full SEM	Configural	.807	.133	–	–	Same broad structure across the 13 countries.
S4 country-level, full SEM	Metric	.798	.131	-.010	-.002	Supports comparison of relationships, ranks, and profiles.
S4 country-level, full SEM	Scalar	.772	.134	-.026	.003	Weaker support; absolute latent means need caveats.
S4 language-level	Metric	.796	.131	-.011	-.002	Near threshold; language comparisons need caution.

Conventional rule: Δ CFI $\geq$ -.010 supports the more constrained step.

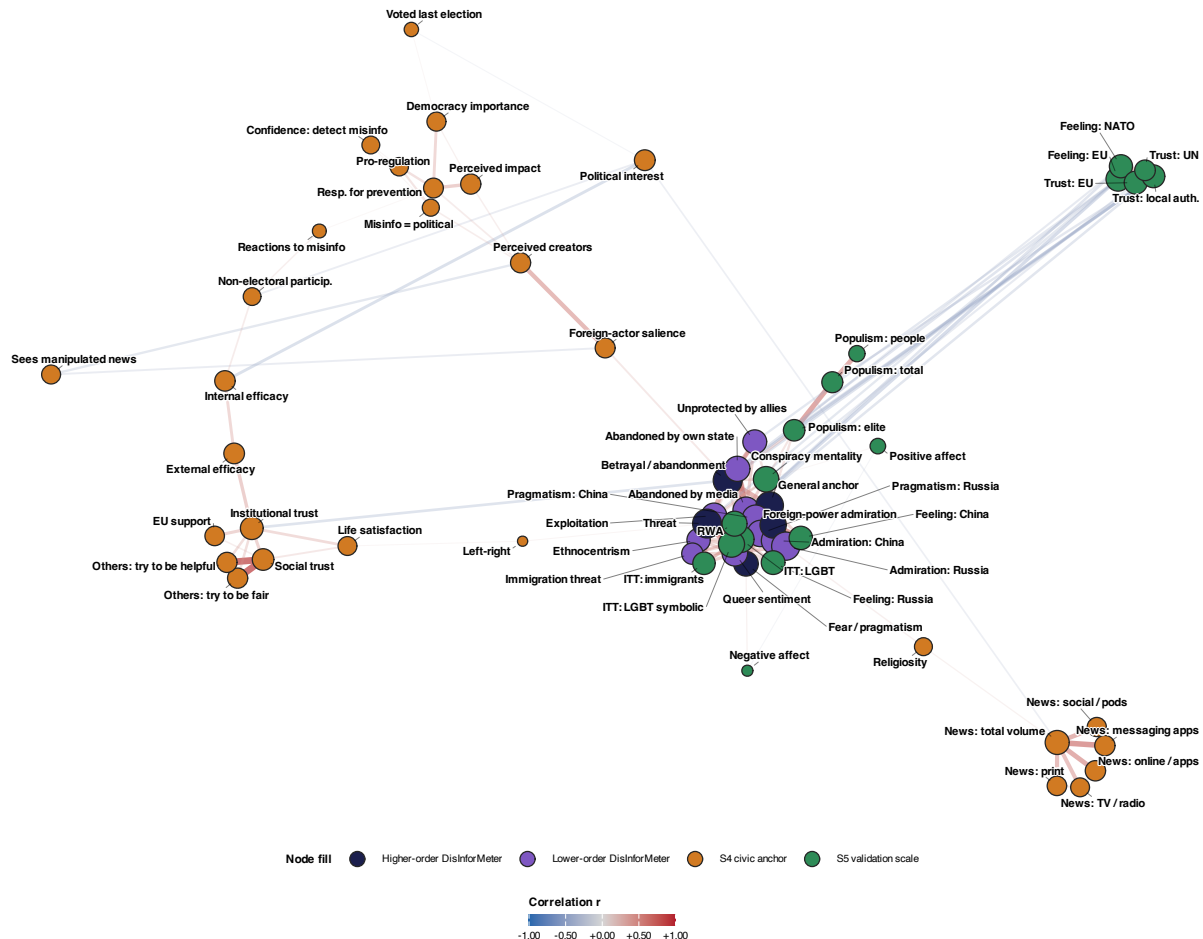
Table 6: FIMI variant correlations and reliability

S4 variant	Items	α	ω	Correlation with Full FIMI	Policy reading
Full FIMI	8	.690	.694	1.000	Primary S4 detection indicator.
Russian-origin FIMI	5	.654	.659	.914	Highly aligned with Full FIMI but retains source-specific information.
Chinese-origin FIMI	3	.418	.433	.750	Distinct enough to expose the Chinese-origin detection blind spot.
Short FIMI	4	.529	.532	.890	Useful source-balanced sensitivity variant, not a replacement for the Full FIMI battery.

D. Annex D: Network and Country Supplements

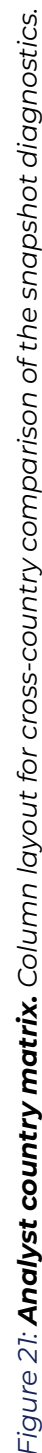
Full nomological network backbone

Adaptive edge pruning keeps the strongest global and local relationships while preserving every node in the full network.



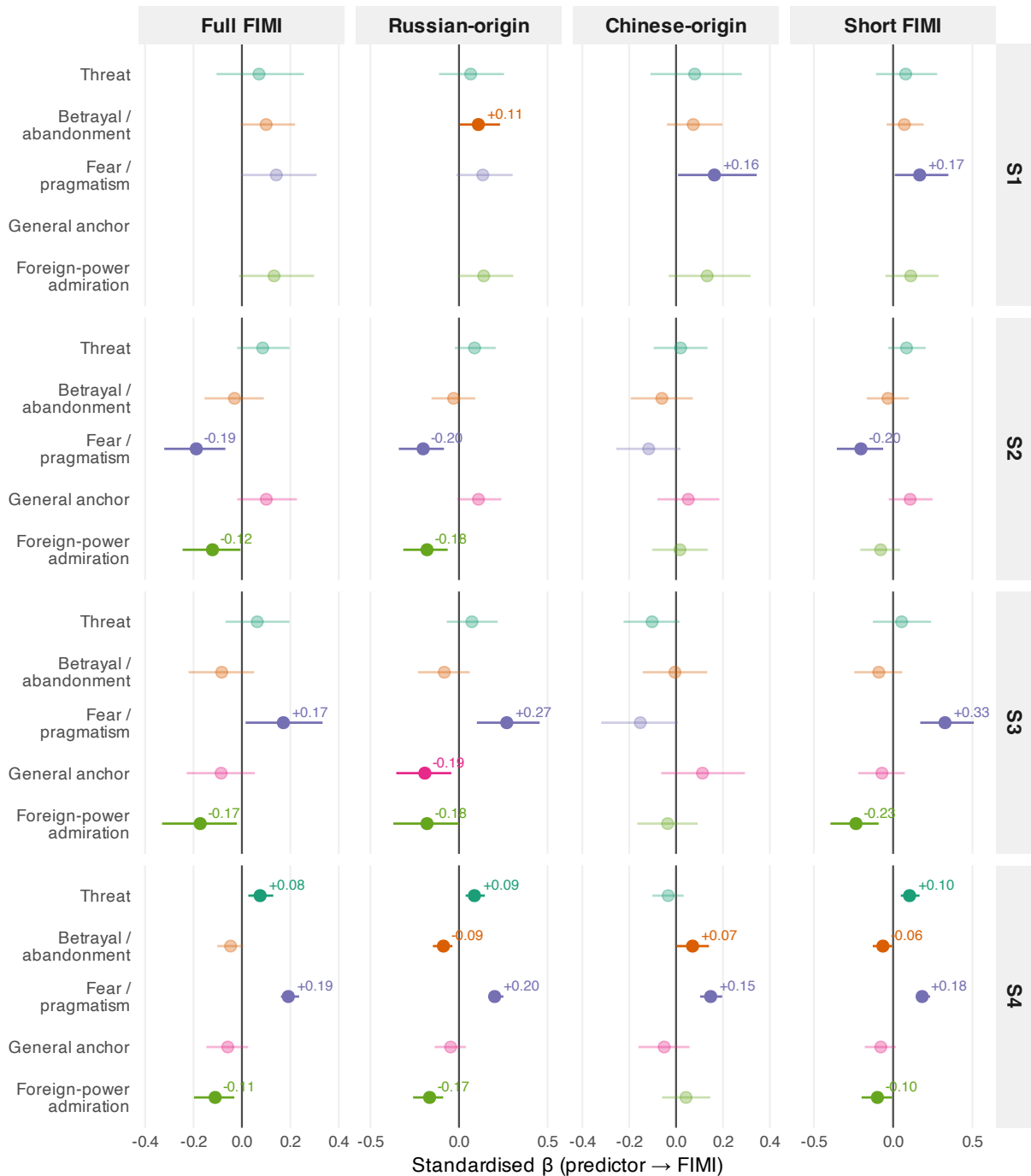
Backbone view of the full pairwise S4 + S5 network. Statistics were calculated for all 1108 available unique pairs; this display keeps 197 adaptive-backbone edges: global $|r| \geq 0.35$, each node's 2 strongest ties, plus a maximum-spanning skeleton so all nodes remain visible. Node fill = type. N = 1,108.

*Figure 20: **Full-network backbone.** Adaptive-pruned network supplement for the full civic-anchor and validation-scale field. Layout is interpretive; numeric correlations are in the source tables.*



Higher-order predictors of FIMI across studies and operationalisations

Each cell is the standardised β (95 % CI) from the canonical higher-order composite SEM. Non-significant estimates ($p \geq .05$) are dimmed.

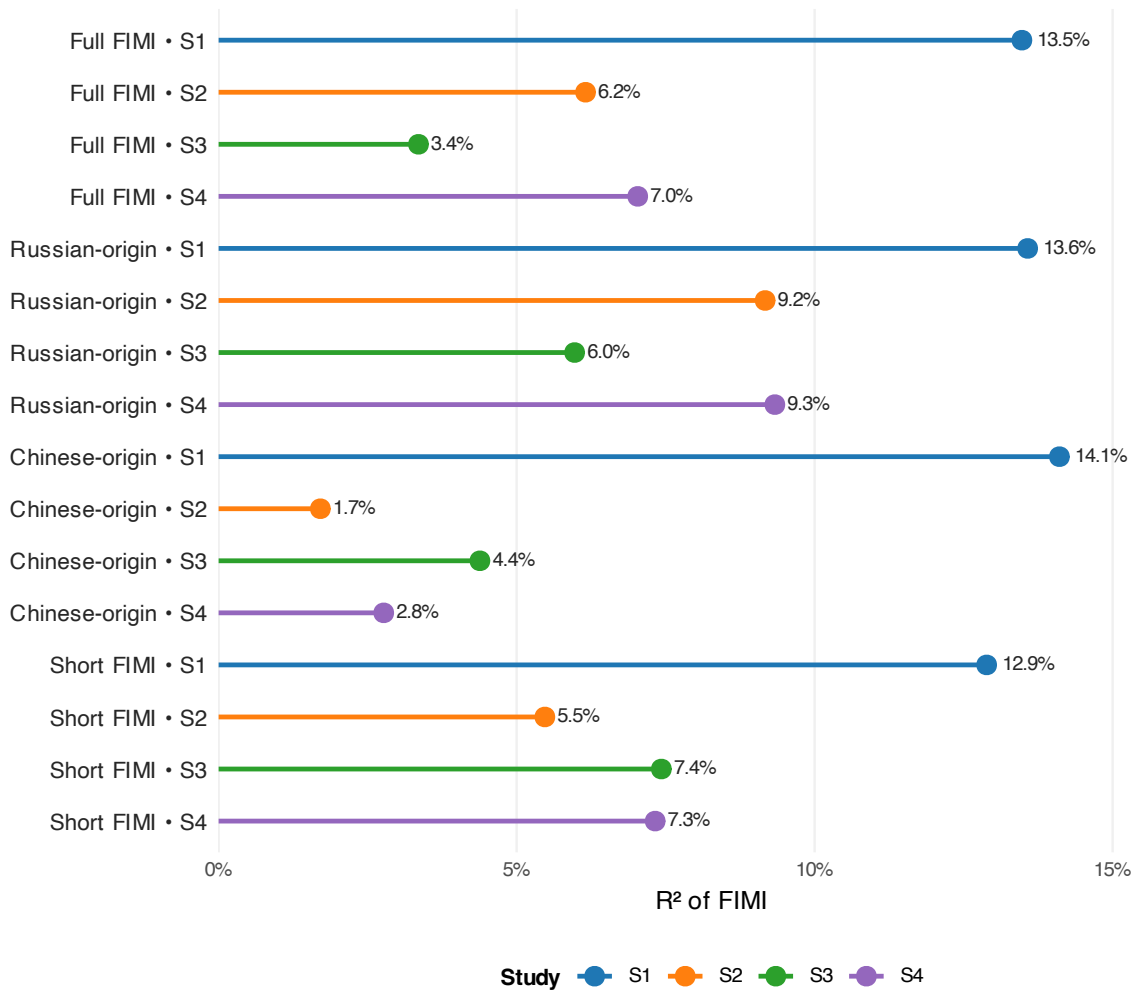


Standardised β with 95 % CI from the higher-order composite (COMP) SEM in each study. Rows = study, columns = FIMI operationalisation; 28 of 76 cells are significant at $p < .05$ (dimmed cells are non-significant). N = 76.

Figure 22: Cross-study predictor paths by FIMI operationalisation. Standardised predictor-to-FIMI paths from the canonical higher-order composite SEM across studies and FIMI variants. This cross-study figure is retained as a technical supplement; the main-text policy interpretation uses the S4 country-by-variant BRMS figure.

How much FIMI variance does each model explain? (R^2)

Higher-order composite SEM (one row per study $\times$ FIMI variant). Bars show R^2 (proportion of FIMI variance explained).

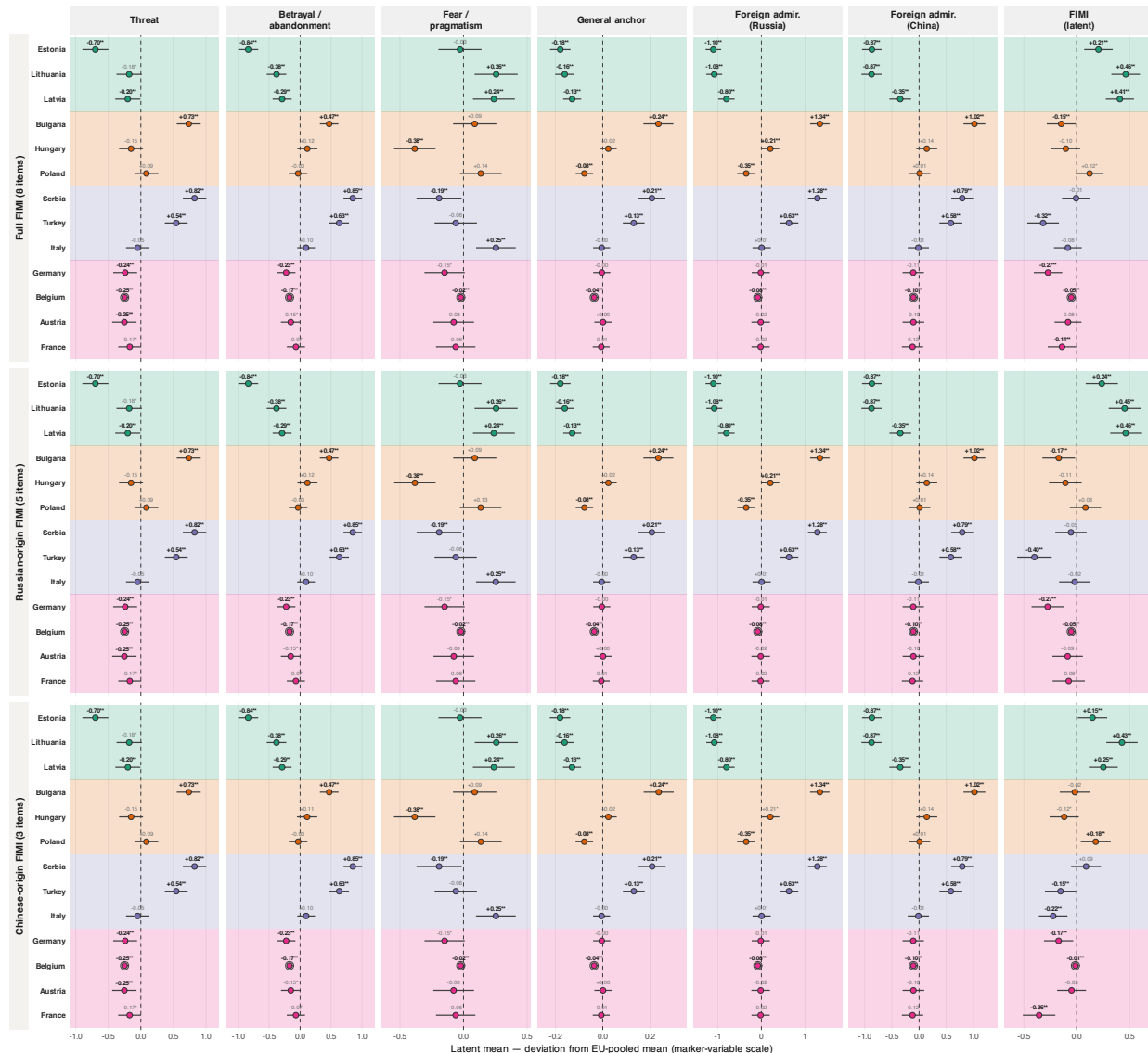


Cells show the variance in FIMI explained by the higher-order composite (COMP) SEM in each study $\times$ operationalisation. One lollipop per cell; bars start at zero. Y axis grouped by FIMI variant, then study (S1 $\rightarrow$ S4). N = 16.

Figure 23: Explained variance across prediction models. Model R^2 by study and FIMI operationalisation. The panel provides scale for the predictive models and discourages over-reading individual path coefficients.

Country latent means by FIMI operationalisation — 6 predictors + FIMI factor

Multi-group scalar-invariant CFA (08c) repeated for the three FIMI DVs. Filled dot = country posterior estimate; whisker = 95 % CI; dashed line = EU-pooled grand mean; open dark ring = reference country. Within a column, the three rows share the same x-axis so cross-DV stability is readable down the column.



Country LATENT MEANS across the three FIMI operationalisations. Each row is a separate multi-group scalar-invariant CFA (08c) including the six predictor factors AND a FIMI latent built from that variant's news items. Within a column, the three rows share the same x-axis. Filled dot = country posterior estimate; whisker = 95 % CI; dashed line = EU-pooled grand mean (zero by construction after centering); open dark ring = reference country (alpha = 0). Labels above the dot: centred mean with ** = 95 % CI excludes 0, * = 90 % CI excludes 0, 161 of 273 cells credible at 95 %. The first six columns should be visually near-identical across rows — the predictor measurement model does not depend on the FIMI item set — and divergence in the FIMI column is the substantive cross-DV signal. Fit indices: Full FIMI (8 items): $\chi^2(449) = 2304$, CFI = 0.763, RMSEA = 0.068, SRMR = 0.124; Russian-origin FIMI (5 items): $\chi^2(341) = 2311$, CFI = 0.769, RMSEA = 0.109, SRMR = 0.133; Chinese-origin FIMI (3 items): $\chi^2(204) = 2387$, CFI = 0.773, RMSEA = 0.116, SRMR = 0.138. If a row's CFI < .50 / RMSEA > .08, treat that variant's means as a sensitivity check and consider partial-scalar refinement in 08c. N = 273.

Figure 24: **Scalar latent means by FIMI variant.** Technical supplement for latent-mean diagnostics across countries and FIMI variants. Interpret with scalar-invariance caveats.

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